TEST SCHOOL

Answer Key and Marking Scheme

Annual Examination 2026 · English

Maximum Marks: 100 **Pass Mark: 33**

TO THE EXAMINER

1. Award marks strictly according to the value points listed against each question.
2. A correct answer expressed in the student's own words earns full marks.
3. Where a question carries sub-parts, mark each part independently.
4. The chapter and page reference under each answer is where the question came from. Anything marked **from your class notes** came from the notes rather than the textbook, so the page number is theirs and not the book's.

SECTION A — OBJECTIVE

1. [1 mark] Correct option: (b) The colours in the dress were extremely bright and striking.

1. The vivid colours of the dress drew her attention away from the head. — 1.0

The Hundred Dresses ¥II › The Story of Wanda's Drawing · page 89

2. [1 mark] Correct option: (c) Blood had trickled from the airholes and chinks of the lid.

1. The presence of blood around the box openings showed the animal was injured during the struggle. — 1.0

Mijbil the Otter › Transportation Challenges · page 117

3. [1 mark] Correct option: (c) Peggy draws better than anyone else in the room.

1. The identification of Peggy's superior drawing ability as the reason for her expected win. — 1.0

The Hundred Dresses ¥I › The Drawing Contest · page 78

4. [1 mark] Correct option: (c) God

1. Identified God as the signature used. — 1.0

A Letter to God › Story Analysis Questions · page 17

5. [1 mark] Correct option: (b) can’t

1. Correctly identifying the contracted form provided in the text. — 1.0

From the Diary of Anne Frank › Contracted Forms · page 68

6. [1 mark] Correct option: (b) He was eager to reach home and enjoy a meal.

1. Correct identification of the narrator's desire for home and breakfast as the motive. — 1.0

Two Stories about Flying › The Black Aeroplane (Narrative) · page 47

7. [1 mark] Correct option: (c) They are worth approximately 300 roubles.

1. Selecting the correct monetary value for the Meadows. — 1.0

The Proposal › Land Ownership Dispute · page 159

8. [1 mark] Correct option: (c) To show Natalya that the land belongs to him.

1. Identifying the purpose of taking the matter to court. — 1.0

The Proposal › Land Ownership Dispute · page 159

9. [1 mark] Correct option: (a) A deep ditch and green fields.

1. Correct identification of the landscape features on the side opposite the canal. — 1.0

Madam Rides the Bus › Interactions on the Bus · page 131

10. [1 mark] Correct option: (c) She claimed to have a hundred dresses.

1. Wanda claimed to have a hundred dresses. — 1.0

The Hundred Dresses ¥II › The Story of Wanda's Drawing · page 89

11. [1 mark] Correct option: (c) She blinks away tears.

1. Maddie blinks away tears when thinking of Wanda. — 1.0

The Hundred Dresses ¥II › The Story of Wanda's Drawing · page 89

12. [1 mark] Correct option: (c) Return became impractical.

1. Correctly identifies that return became impractical. — 1.0

Glimpses of India › Coorgi Ethnic Origins · page 100

13. [1 mark] Correct option: (c) The playing of two national anthems by both black and white citizens.

1. Selection of the correct option identifying the national anthems as the symbol of the day. — 1.0

Nelson Mandela Long Walk to Freedom › Military and National Anthems · page 29

14. [1 mark] Correct option: (b) Writing a diary is like speaking to oneself.

1. Identifying the reason for using contracted forms in diaries based on the provided text. — 1.0

From the Diary of Anne Frank › Contracted Forms · page 68

15. [1 mark] Correct option: (b) The box could not exceed eighteen inches square.

1. The airline mandated a specific size for the travel container. — 1.0

Mijbil the Otter › Transportation Challenges · page 117

16. [1 mark] Correct option: (b) They are distinct from the Hindu mainstream.

1. Correctly notes the distinctness from the Hindu mainstream. — 1.0

Glimpses of India › Coorgi Ethnic Origins · page 100

17. [1 mark] Correct option: (b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.

1. Correctly identifying that both statements are factually supported by the text's mention of grief's nature and the existence of external expectations. — 1.0

The Sermon at Benares › Comparative Approaches to Grief · page 146

18. [1 mark] Correct option: (a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.

1. Correctly identifying that the assertion and reason are both supported by the text and the reason explains the cause of the assertion. — 1.0

Two Stories about Flying › Physical and Emotional Experience of Flight · page 45

19. [1 mark] Correct option: (a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.

1. The assertion and reason are both supported by the text, and the age directly supports the claim of it being a critical age. — 1.0

The Proposal › Character Interactions and Plot Development · page 154

20. [1 mark] Correct option: (a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.

1. Correctly linking the need to respect privacy with the fact that some grieving individuals do not wish to share their experience. — 1.0

The Sermon at Benares › Comparative Approaches to Grief · page 146

SECTION B — VERY SHORT ANSWER

21. [2 marks]
The author of the play is Anton Chekhov, who was a Russian short story writer and dramatist.

1. Identified the author as Anton Chekhov. — 1.0
2. Mentioned his profession as a Russian short story writer and dramatist. — 1.0

The Proposal › The Play 'The Proposal' by Anton Chekhov · page 153

22. [2 marks]
Valli told the conductor she could get on by herself and did not need his help. This reveals that she was independent and determined.

1. Stated she told the conductor she could get on by herself. — 1.0
2. Identified that this action shows her independent or self-reliant nature. — 1.0

Madam Rides the Bus › Valli's Attempt to Ride the Bus · page 129

23. [2 marks]
Mijbil was aloof and indifferent towards the author. He kept his distance by choosing to sleep on the floor as far away from the author's bed as possible.

1. The otter was aloof and indifferent. — 1.0
2. The otter stayed as far as possible from the author's bed. — 1.0

Mijbil the Otter › Otter Behavior and Adaptation · page 115

24. [2 marks]
A person must draw out the arrow of lamentation, complaint, and grief. By doing this, they become composed and free from sorrow.

1. They must draw out the arrow of lamentation, complaint, and grief. — 1.0
2. The result is that they obtain peace of mind and become free from sorrow. — 1.0

OR

The marriages are encouraged to increase the family's estates and to make good economic sense for wealthy families.

The Sermon at Benares › Kisa Gotami's Understanding of Death · page 145

25. [2 marks]
Mijbil would lie on his back and juggle marbles on his wide, flat belly. He rolled them up and down without letting them drop to the floor.

1. He played by lying on his back. — 1.0
2. He rolled marbles on his belly without dropping them. — 1.0

Mijbil the Otter › Otter Behavior and Adaptation · page 115

26. [2 marks]
The postmaster realized the letter required money because Lencho asked for a hundred pesos to sow his field again and live until the next crop.

1. The letter requested financial aid (a hundred pesos). — 1.0
2. The money was necessary for sowing the field and survival until the next harvest. — 1.0

OR

Ivan Lomov is the character who visits Chubukov, and they are long-time wealthy neighbours.
A Letter to God › The Postmaster's Response · page 16

27. [2 marks]
Kisa Gotami asks for medicine to cure her dead son. She does not get it because there is no medicine that can bring a dead person back to life.

1. She asks for medicine for her dead son. — 1.0
2. She does not get it because death is inevitable and cannot be reversed by medicine. — 1.0

The Sermon at Benares › Kisa Gotami's Understanding of Death · page 145

28. [2 marks]
The phrase signifies having a large amount of something to deal with. It is used when someone is overwhelmed by a heavy workload.

1. Defining the phrase as having a lot of something to deal with. — 1.0
2. Identifying that it relates to being overwhelmed by tasks or work. — 1.0

From the Diary of Anne Frank › Vocabulary and Idioms · page 67

29. [2 marks]
Maddie's action signifies her sense of discomfort and moral conflict while witnessing Peggy's bullying. She avoids direct involvement and confrontation by focusing on her own physical objects.

1. It shows Maddie's sense of embarrassment regarding Peggy's behavior. — 1.0
2. It highlights her attempt to remain passive or detached from the mocking situation. — 1.0

The Hundred Dresses ¥I › Maddie's Internal Conflict · page 77

30. [2 marks]
She threatened that he would be left to starve unless he flew away from the ledge.

1. She threatened to let him starve. — 1.0
2. The condition for avoiding starvation was that he must fly away. — 1.0

Two Stories about Flying › Family Dynamics and Encouragement · page 44

SECTION C — SHORT ANSWER

---

31. [3 marks]
The mother was looking at the young seagull, tearing at a piece of fish, and scraping each side of her beak on the rock.

1. She was looking at the young seagull. — 1.0
2. She tore at a piece of fish. — 1.0
3. She scraped each side of her beak on the rock. — 1.0

OR

The communication failed because the line was out of order on the first day, the exchange was closed for a religious holiday on the second day, and there was a breakdown on the third day.
Two Stories about Flying › The Young Seagull's First Flight · page 44

32. [3 marks]
To return home, Valli had to stay in her seat on the bus after reaching the town. She then needed to pay an additional thirty paise for the return journey. By following these steps, she could travel back on the same bus.

1. Valli must reach the town on the bus. — 1.0
2. She must remain in her seat. — 1.0
3. She must pay another thirty paise for the return trip. — 1.0

Madam Rides the Bus › The Bus Journey Details · page 128

33. [3 marks]
The sight of the food maddened him, he remembered how much he loved to tear food that way, and he liked scraping his beak to whet it.

1. The sight of the food maddened him. — 1.0
2. He loved to tear food in that manner. — 1.0
3. He enjoyed scraping his beak to whet it. — 1.0

Two Stories about Flying › The Young Seagull's First Flight · page 44

34. [3 marks]
The narrator learned that otters were found in the Tigris marshes, they were as common as mosquitoes there, and they were often tamed by the Arabs.

1. Otters are located in the Tigris marshes. — 1.0
2. They are as common as mosquitoes in that region. — 1.0
3. They are often tamed by the Arabs. — 1.0

Mijbil the Otter › Acquiring an Otter · page 113

35. [3 marks]
The baker collected his bills at the end of the month, and these monthly accounts were recorded on a wall using a pencil.

1. The baker collected his bills at the end of the month. — 1.0
2. Accounts were recorded on a wall. — 1.0
3. The recording was done using a pencil. — 1.0

Glimpses of India › Baker's Profession and Economic Status · page 97

36. [3 marks]
The well-dressed man considered thirty paise to be 'almost nothing at all'. However, to Valli, thirty paise represented a significant amount of money because she rarely possessed that much money in a month. This difference in perception existed because the man likely had more wealth than Valli.

1. The man thought the fare was almost nothing. — 1.0
2. Valli rarely saw that much money in a month. — 1.0
3. To Valli, the amount seemed like a fortune. — 1.0

Madam Rides the Bus › The Bus Journey Details · page 128

37. [3 marks]
Weeping and grieving do not provide peace of mind, they increase physical pain, and they cause the body to suffer.

1. Weeping and grieving do not result in obtaining peace of mind. — 1.0
2. Grieving causes an individual's pain to become greater. — 1.0
3. The act of grieving causes physical suffering to the body. — 1.0

OR

The brothers and sister were dozing with their heads sunk into their necks, and the father was preening the feathers on his white back.
The Sermon at Benares › The Buddha's Sermon on Death · page 145

38. [3 marks]
Lencho spent the morning watching the sky towards the north-east because he knew his fields needed a downpour or a shower to ensure a good harvest.

1. He spent the morning watching the sky. — 1.0
2. He was looking towards the north-east. — 1.0
3. He did this because the earth needed a downpour or shower for the harvest. — 1.0

A Letter to God › Lencho's Hope and Faith · page 13

39. [3 marks]
The children react with disbelief, they stop their current activities like hopscotch, and they listen intently to the exchange between Peggy and Wanda.

1. The children express disbelief at the claim. — 1.0
2. The younger children cease their game of hopscotch. — 1.0
3. The children shift their focus to listen to the conversation. — 1.0

OR

Maddie wanted to tell Wanda that they were sorry for picking on her, express that the school thought she was wonderful, and ask her not to move away while promising that everyone would be nice to her.
The Hundred Dresses ¥I › Peggy and Maddie's Teasing · page 75

40. [3 marks]
Maddie decided she would never again stand by silently, she would speak up if anyone was mocked for their appearance or name, and she was prepared to risk losing Peggy's friendship to do so.

1. She decided she would never again stand by and say nothing. — 1.0
2. She decided to speak up if she heard anyone being teased for being funny looking or having strange names. — 1.0
3. She accepted that she might lose Peggy's friendship as a consequence of her stance. — 1.0

The Hundred Dresses ¥II › Maddie's Internal Conflict and Realization · page 85

SECTION D — LONG ANSWER

---

41. [5 marks]
Lencho observed that big drops of rain began to fall. In the north-east, huge mountains of clouds were visible. The clouds appeared to be approaching. The air felt fresh. The air also felt sweet.

1. Mentioning the big drops of rain. — 1.0
2. Noting the appearance of huge mountains of clouds. — 1.0
3. Mentioning the location of the clouds in the north-east. — 1.0
4. Describing the air as fresh. — 1.0
5. Describing the air as sweet. — 1.0

OR

The sight that brought Valli joy was the bus. This bus was filled with passengers. Each time the bus passed, it carried a new set of passengers. This was a source of unending joy for her. This constant change of people was the core of her fascination.
A Letter to God › The Hailstorm and Its Impact · page 14

42. [5 marks]
First, Peggy focuses only on what she did not do, rather than addressing the actual teasing she did perform. Second, she uses these specific examples as a benchmark for 'good' behavior, implying that as long as she avoided those specific acts, she was not really bullying Wanda. Third, this highlights a compartmentalized morality where she ignores the broader impact of her actions by strictly defining her own acceptable boundaries.

1. Peggy uses selective denial by focusing only on specific actions she avoided. — 2.0
2. She sets a low bar for her own conduct to justify her actions as acceptable. — 1.0
3. The defense demonstrates a failure to see her behavior as systemic bullying. — 2.0

The Hundred Dresses ¥II › Peggy's Justification for Her Behavior · page 85

43. [5 marks]

Sanne was a friend of Anne who was good at poetry. She offered to help Anne write the essay from beginning to end in verse, which provided a creative solution when Anne felt she had nearly exhausted her own ingenuity on the topic.

1. Identified Sanne as a friend who is good at poetry. — 2.0
2. Explained that she helped write the entire essay in verse. — 2.0
3. Noted that this assistance helped Anne when she was running out of ideas. — 1.0

OR

Valli listened carefully to conversations. She listened to her neighbours. She also listened to people who regularly used the bus. She asked a few discreet questions here and there. She performed these actions over many days and months.

From the Diary of Anne Frank › Anne's Interaction with Mr. Keesing · page 63

44. [5 marks]

Wanda did not have any friends. She walked to school by herself. She returned home alone as well.

1. She lacked any friends. — 2.0
2. She arrived at school alone. — 1.5
3. She departed for home alone. — 1.5

The Hundred Dresses ¥I › Wanda's Appearance and Absence · page 75

45. [5 marks]

The phrase refers to the assembly of diverse people at the inauguration. Firstly, it indicates that people of various skin colours were present together. Secondly, it signifies the inclusion of different national or ethnic groups. Thirdly, it acts as a metaphor for unity, much like the colours in a rainbow. Fourthly, it contrasts with the previous era of white supremacy in the country. Finally, it highlights the peaceful coming together of the nation to witness the birth of a non-racial government.

1. It represents the inclusion of people of different skin colours. — 1.0
2. It denotes the presence of various nations or ethnic groups. — 1.0
3. It serves as a metaphor for unity and harmony. — 1.0
4. It marks a departure from the history of white supremacy. — 1.0
5. It celebrates the installation of a democratic, non-racial government. — 1.0

Nelson Mandela Long Walk to Freedom › The Inauguration Ceremony · page 27

46. [5 marks]

The two customs are the stealing of the bride by the groom's friends and the stealing of the bride's shoe by the bride's friends. In both cases, the groom must pay a fee or money to get the bride back or to retrieve the shoe.

1. Friends steal the bride, and the groom must pay a fee to find her. — 2.0
2. The bride's friends steal her shoe. — 1.0
3. The groom must pay money to the bride's friends to get the shoe back. — 2.0

OR

First, Peggy attempts to reframe her repetitive and intimidating questioning as a helpful or creative inspiration for Wanda. Second, by suggesting Wanda benefited from the interaction, Peggy avoids confronting the fact that her questions were originally intended to mock Wanda. Third, this argument serves to justify her past curiosity as something productive, thereby neutralizing the moral weight of her previous harassment.

The Proposal › Wedding Customs in Russia and India · page 153

END OF ANSWER KEY